LOGICAL FALLACIES GUIDED NOTES

Name:

Complete this sheet as we work through the lecture together.

1. Hasty **Generalization**

An inference drawn from insufficient evidence

Ex:

2. **Faulty Causality**

Incorrect assumption that one event caused another event

correlation does not imply causation.

3. **Either/Or**

Unfair oversimplification of an issue by providing only two options as a possible solution

"If you aren't first, you're last."

(The flawed logic of Ricky Bobby.)

4. **Slippery Slope**

Exaggeration of the likely consequences of an action, designed to show that a misstep

_____ could result in a

_____ in the future

5. Bandwagon

Arguments urging you to follow the same path that everyone else is taking

This technique is commonly used to sway these two groups:

teenagers and voters

6. Sentimental **Appeal**

Playing on readers' emotions to distract them from the facts

7. **Scare Tactics**

Using fear to sway people by exaggerating possible dangers well beyond their statistical likelihood

8. **Appeal to False Authority**

Presenting an unqualified person or institution as source of credible information

9. **Ad Hominem**

In Latin, this means: to the man

When you attack a person's character instead of the quality of his/her ideas

tu quoque is a specific type of ad hominem when you basically call someone a hypocrite instead of debating his/her ideas

10. **Straw Man**

Misrepresenting or twisting someone's argument so it's easier to attack and knock down

Highly Illogical: Name that Fallacy

Strong arguments are void of logical fallacies. Weak arguments are often bolstered by the common fallacies listed in the box below. Your job is to correctly identify the fallacy being used in each of the following arguments. All of the fallacies are used at least once, but some (obviously) will be used more than once.

faulty causality
_____ 1. My grandmother ate 10 cloves of raw garlic every day. Not surprisingly, she lived to be 102.

bandwagon
_____ 2. I guess I should buy my 12-year-old daughter an iPhone. Everyone at her new school has one and I want her to fit in with the other kids.

either/or
_____ 3. If you don't say the Pledge of Allegiance, then you must be a traitor.

faulty causality
_____ 4. Every time I wash my car, it rains the next day. My car washing definitely affects the weather.

scare tactic
_____ 5. Studies show it takes up to seven years for the human body to digest a piece of gum.

straw man
_____ 6. Charlie: I think we should put more money into schools. Quality public education is so important.
Bob: So you're saying we should cut military spending and spend it instead on more spiral notebooks and crayons? I guess you want our country to be a weak, defenseless target for terrorists.

either/or
_____ 7. I'm raising funds to help cure XYZ disease. If you don't donate, then you're part of the problem.

faulty causality
_____ 8. Many women claim that they want to live in a peaceful world, but we must remember that there were no nuclear weapons before women were given the right to vote.

Common Fallacies

A. Hasty Generalization
B. Faulty Causality
C. Either/Or
D. Slippery Slope
E. Bandwagon
F. Sentimental Appeal
G. Scare Tactic
H. Appeal to False Authority
I. Ad Hominem
J. Straw Man

_____ 9. My opponent raises a good point, but can we really trust him? I mean, he moved to this town only two years ago and everyone knows that his wife left him.

_____ 10. The economy continues to grow as the number of "likes" on my Instagram account continue to increase. Clearly, the two are linked.

_____ 11. My cousin Bob works as a mechanic at Oil Changers and he says that renewable energy sources, such as solar and wind power, aren't going to provide any help in fixing our nation's energy crisis.

_____ 12. Oh, please. What would you know about labor laws? You don't even have a job.

_____ 13. I know you don't like the kitty-cat sweater that Grandma knitted for you, but she worked so hard on it and it will make her happy to see you wear it in the family holiday photo.

_____ 14. Charlie: Fast food is filled with salt, fat, and added sugars. We need better regulation of the industry.
Bob: That may be, but you're such a hypocrite! I saw you devour a Triple-Baconator, super-sized fries, and 64 ounces of soda yesterday.

_____ 15. If I don't take this A.P. class, then I won't do well on the exam. If I don't do well on the A.P. exam, then I can't get into a good college. If I can't get into a good college, then I'll never get a good job. If I can't get a good job, then I'm going to have to live in my parents' basement forever. Guess I'll sign up for the A.P. class.

_____ 16. Global chocolate consumption is highest in Switzerland, yet people there are among the trimmest in the industrialized world. Therefore, it's reasonable to conclude that chocolate helps keep your weight down.

_____ 17. There is definitely a link between autism and the vaccines given to toddlers. I know this because a Wikipedia entry mentioned numerous studies that found this to be true.

_____ 18. We think this new MallTime game app will be a success because all little girls like shopping.

_____ 19. Medical expenses for the elderly continue to rise. If you don't buy long-term health care insurance now, you probably won't be able to qualify once you're older. Sure, the insurance policy is a little expensive, but it's worth spending the money today so you don't go bankrupt in the future, becoming a burden to your family.

_____ 20. Charlie: Illegal posting and sharing of songs online is crippling the music industry.
Bob: You couldn't be more wrong; the music industry is doing just fine. I can't believe you think the government should be allowed to regulate what I share with my "friends." No one wants a world where I can't loan a book to my girlfriend, let my roommate borrow my iPod, or share a funny meme with my blog followers.